

UPASANA ARORA: A CEO WITH A SOFT HEART



In the dynamic landscape of healthcare, leadership serves as the cornerstone for steering organizations towards success. There are certain distinctive traits that set apart the best CEOs in the healthcare industry. Upasana has many of these qualities, to name a few, Visionary Leadership, Strategic Acumen, Patient-Centric Focus and Strong Communication Skills which has brought her to the mantle of Yashoda Super Speciality Hospital, Kaushambi and she is spreading her wings and taking it across the seas.

We take a brief insight on her road to success which has not been a bed of roses but she had endured challenges and overcome them at every step of her life. She started her career as a Director in 2000, which was then a 100-bed facility and she wanted to bring in technological upgradation in the facilities and uplift it to meet the growing demand of patients and be futuristic. This was a challenge for her, particularly considering her position as the youngest member and a woman in the family. She established her role and the family also supported her and she expanded her scope from HR and undertook tasks such as computerizing the hospital and working on quality accreditation thus demonstrating that women excel not only in HR but also in overall management.

As Director of the hospital, she has been contributing to the organisation from 2000 and provided leadership to her team to make it the First NABH Accredited Hospital in Ghaziabad in 2010. She also got her laboratories accredited by NABL in 2011. She had always

believed in continuing education and hence has been continuously updating herself to the latest in the field of healthcare. She did a CII Assessor course in 2011 and then a Certificate in Lean management course in association with Cardiff University, U.K. in 2012. Subsequently she did a Lean deployment across challenging work processes in her organisation. It had a significant impact on improving the supply chain management of medicines for patients in her pharmacy.

She did her NABH Assessor course in 2012 and management courses from IIM Ahmedabad from 2013-2015 and also a Fellowship in Health Technology Assessment from WHO-Anglia Ruskin University. She became the First Indian to be working in India to be awarded the prestigious Fellowship of ISQua (International Society for Quality and Accreditation) in 2015. She did her Quality Leadership programme from Harvard University and subsequently did a practical learning implementation of Six Sigma in 2016 in NHS hospitals in U.K which impacted her thinking of streamlining processes.

She has always been a technological updated person and hence has been constantly upgrading her diagnostics, rehabilitative and therapeutic departments with the latest advancements, along with qualified manpower and infrastructure meeting patient expectations, which keeps her abreast with all her peers. She has focused on quality of patient services and had kept the patient expectations as her first priority which led to the growth of the hospital. She started with a tertiary care hospital in 2006 and expanded the specialties in coherence to patient needs and transformed to a quaternary care hospital in 2017. In addition to all the general specialties, the hospital offers a varied range of Superspeciality services i.e. Cardiology & CTVS, Endocrinology, Gastroenterology, Joint Replacement, Nephrology, Neurology, Oncology, Pulmonology, Urology, Neurosurgery, Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery. The centre has a state of the art Cardiac Cath Lab along with CT Angiography for Interventional Cardiology, Radiology and Cardiothoracic and Vascular Surgeries. With a world class seamless operation theatre complex with HEPA filters and laminar flow maintaining international standards of engineering, operational safety and infection control the hospital has also embarked with Robotic Assisted Surgery with the Da Vinci Robotic Surgery. The hospital is now providing Robotic assisted surgeries in the field of Gynaecology, General